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Organizational Behavior

Introduction

In the business world, "people skills" are paramount for career advancement. While technical expertise may serve you well in the early stages, as you progress into management and leadership roles, your ability to connect with others becomes the determining factor. It's not just about plugging numbers into equations; managing and leading people requires judgment and critical thinking, especially when information is incomplete.

This course focuses on fundamental aspects of managing and leading people in organizations. We delve into understanding human behavior, motivating employees, building trust and commitment, managing relationships and conflict, fostering teamwork, developing talent, and cultivating a shared sense of purpose.

By drawing from theory, empirical research, and practical frameworks, this class equips you with the tools needed to excel as future leaders. You'll gain a deeper understanding of the complexities of managing and leading people at different organizational levels. Prepare to make meaningful contributions and embark on a rewarding journey as leaders in your respective fields.

Course Objectives & Outcomes

This course has three primary objectives that will guide our journey:

Empowering through people: We aim to develop a deeper comprehension of the fundamental motivations that drive people's behavior and explore strategies to influence and inspire those motivations. By understanding what motivates individuals, we can unlock their full potential and foster a culture of empowerment.

Building effective relationships: We will delve into the art of cultivating meaningful interpersonal relationships within the workplace. This entails understanding the dynamics of power and influence, as well as learning effective conflict resolution techniques. Additionally, we will focus on nurturing talent, fostering teamwork, and fostering organizational cultures that align with the company's mission.

Thriving in the global business landscape: As leaders in a globalized world, it is essential to grasp how to develop and guide people in diverse cultural contexts. Through real-world cases spanning multiple continents, we will enhance your ability to identify, adapt to, and thrive in various organizational settings. This will equip you with the skills needed to navigate the

complexities of the global business environment.

These objectives form the pillars of our course, propelling you toward a deeper understanding of organizational behavior and empowering you to excel as future leaders in the ever-evolving business landscape.

Basic

- CB7. The students know how to apply the knowledge acquired and their ability to solve problems in new or unfamiliar environments within broader (or multidisciplinary) contexts related to their area of ??study.
- CB8. The students can integrate knowledge and face the complexity of formulating judgments based on information that, being incomplete or limited, includes reflections on social and ethical responsibilities linked to the application of their knowledge and judgments.
- CB9. Students know how to communicate their conclusions and the knowledge and ultimate reasons that support them to specialized and non-specialized audiences in a clear and unambiguous way.
- CB10. Students possess the learning skills that allow them to continue studying in a way that will be largely self-directed or autonomous.

General

- CG1 - Listen, understand, and contrast the points of view of others to make an objective composition of a business situation. Communicate in a structured and persuasive way. (Interpersonal communication).
- CG2 - Work effectively in multicultural teams, assuming the leadership of a project when required. Integrate the value of diversity in the decision process and teamwork. (Ability to work in multicultural teams).
- CG3 - Critically evaluate the information and the context of a business situation to reach its own conclusionsfor making prudential decisions. (Critical thinking).
- CG4 - Acquire the self-knowledge and self-control necessary to work effectively in professional environments under pressure, understanding the motivations of others and the culture of the company. (Emotional intelligence).

Specific

- CE01 - Identify the relevant data to diagnose a business problem and generate sensible decision alternatives.
- CE07 - Develop rigorous business plans that achieve viability status as scrutinized by real investors.
- CE14 - Identify the mechanisms of team management that generate an environment of collaboration, communication, trust, and achievement of the common goal.

Methodology

The correlation between course evaluation and course objectives is outlined below:

Doing things through people: Team meetings serve as a practical laboratory where the concepts of leadership, motivation, conflict, power, and culture, among others, come to life.

Students are encouraged to reflect on their team's performance and processes. Their active participation in class is an indication of the quality of their team discussions within small groups. Success in the course is closely tied to the ability to effectively engage and collaborate with others.

Effective and meaningful interpersonal relationships: The course content delves into the dynamics of interpersonal relationships within the workplace, with specific emphasis on power and influence, conflict management, talent development, and teams. The level of students' participation in class reflects their grasp of these fundamental concepts. Furthermore, their personal experiences in teamwork and team meetings provide valuable opportunities to reflect on fostering effective interpersonal relationships.

Global business environment: The course covers the exploration of diverse cultural contexts, and students' participation in class should demonstrate their understanding of this material. However, the most profound learning about global environments often arises from their own experiences of closely working under pressure with culturally diverse teams. These real-world encounters contribute significantly to their understanding of global dynamics.

In essence, the course evaluation serves as a window into the extent to which students have absorbed and applied the course's key principles. It assesses their ability to collaborate, build strong relationships, and navigate global business environments. The evaluation process encourages students to reflect on their experiences, linking theoretical knowledge with practical application, and ultimately preparing them for success in the interconnected world of organizational behavior.

Evaluation

The course grade will be determined as of IESE policies. It will be calculated as follows:

Description	Percentage
Written assignment (report, individual or team-based) (SE2)	40%
Performance in class (SE4)	60%

Content

The course is structured into three modules, each exploring essential aspects of OB:

Leadership: This module delves into the core elements of effective people leadership. We dissect three crucial levers: power, authority, and trust. By examining these concepts, we gain insights into leadership styles and explore cutting-edge organizational leadership perspectives. You will understand comprehensively what it takes to lead with impact, including how to lead in uncertain environments and in an increasingly AI-enabled workplace.

Self-Management: In this module, we turn our attention inward and explore individual motivation. We delve into the different types of motives, distinguishing between extrinsic and intrinsic motivations and pro-self and pro-social orientations. Additionally, we investigate the intricacies of personality, productivity, emotional intelligence, stress management, achieving personal-professional balance, relationship styles, happiness, and overall well-being. This

module equips you with the tools to effectively navigate your own growth and development, fostering personal and professional success.

Teams: The final module centers around the art of managing teams within global and diverse business contexts. We unravel the complexities of team dynamics, emphasizing the skills needed to lead and coordinate teams, manage conflict, and foster collaboration in a way that maximizes their potential. Through practical examples and case studies, we explore the challenges and opportunities that arise when working with diverse teams. By the end of this module, you willpossess the knowledge and strategies necessary to foster high-performing teams in a globalized world.

These modules form the backbone of our course, encompassing the essential pillars of leadership, self-management, and effective team management. By immersing yourself in these areas, you will develop the skills and insights needed to thrive in the dynamic landscape of organizational behavior.

Course Outline

Session 1	**Introduction to Organizational Behavior**
Case	Hausser Foods Products Company (CU01)
Post-class reading	Business or Enterprise? Different approaches to the management of people in organizations (DPON-364-E)

Session 2	**Motivation**
Case	Luis Arrese A, B, C, D (DPO-801-E to DPO-804-E)
Post-class reading	Basics in Work Motivation (DPON-10-E)

Session 3	**Stress Management**
Case	Lucía Gómez (DPO-462-E)
Post-class reading	Self-Management (DPON-16-E)

Session 4	**Well-being. Lecture**
Post-class reading	How will you measure your life? (R1007B)

Session 5	**Power and Influence**
Case	FIFA 2010. Choosing the best coach in the world (CL0011-PDF-ENG)
Post-class reading	Trust in boss-subordinate relationships (DPON-12-E)

Session 6	**Leading Teams**
Case	Bob Knowlton I (DPO-470-E)
Post-class reading	Dealing with difficult characters: improving work relationships through empathy (DPON-152-E)

Session 7	Conflict and Collaboration
Exercise	Collaboration
Post-class reading	Managing conflicts (DPON-53-E)

Session 8	Leading in an Uncertain World
Case	YouTube CEO Susan Wojcicki: Can she deliver again? (A) (SM-1765-E)
Post-class reading	Leadership in work teams (FHN-325-E)

Session 9	Leadership in an AI-enabled Context
Case	Arie's AI co-leadership dilemma (DPO-919-E)
Post-class reading	What is true, useful, and meaningful?: A leadership lens for AI (DPON-385-E)

Session 10	Leading Global Teams
Case	Managing a Global Team: Greg James at Sun Microsystems, Inc. (9-409-003)
Post-class reading	Managing multi-cultural teams (R0611D)

Bibliography

The readings assigned to each session will provide you with useful theoretical frameworks and practical tools complementing the content discussed in class.

Optional references

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- Dalio, R. *Principles: Life and Work*, Simon & Schuster, 2017.
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- Thomas, D. & Inkson, K.: *Cultural Intelligence: Living and Working Globally*, Berrett-Koehler Publishers, 2009.
- Tolle, E.: *The Power of Now: A Guide to Spiritual Enlightenment*. Namaste Publishing, 2004.

Professor's Biography

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Villamor is an Assistant Professor in the Managing People in Organizations Department at IESE. She holds a Ph.D. in Management from the George Washington University School of Business, an MBA from IESE, and a Bachelor of Business Administration from the University of Navarra.

Her research how the future of work is redefining career equality, how hybrid and virtual work are changing employees' experiences, and why equality gaps persist among leaders and star performers. Her work has been published in academic journals such as the Journal of Management and the Academy of Management Annals, and featured in international media outlets such as Forbes, the World Economic Forum, and El País. She is a recipient of the European Union's Marie Sk?odowska-Curie Actions Grant and regularly presents her research at leading international conferences, including the Academy of Management Meeting.

Prior to her academic career, Isabel worked as a strategy consultant in Europe and Latin America. She also worked in the Strategy and Human Resources departments in the pharmaceutical and energy sectors, as well as for non-profit organizations in Africa and Latin America.

Learning Outcomes

These are the Learning Outcomes:

- Apply well-established ethical criteria in business decision-making, respecting the inherent dignity of each individual and the pursuit of the common good. (Integrity) (R02)
- Identify relevant data to diagnose a business problem and generate sensible decision alternatives. (R03)
- Analyze and design optimized operations and logistics systems focused on customer orientation, following Lean philosophy principles (eliminate non-value-adding activities). (R04)
- Develop rigorous business plans that achieve viability status under the scrutiny of real investors. (R06)
- Enable students to integrate knowledge and address the complexity of making judgments based on incomplete or limited information, including reflections on social and ethical responsibilities linked to the application of their knowledge and judgments. (R11)
- Equip students with learning skills that enable them to continue studying independently and self-directedly. (R12)
- Work effectively in multicultural teams, assuming project leadership when necessary. Integrate the value of diversity into the team's decision-making and work process (Multicultural teamwork skills). (R13)
- Critically evaluate information and the context of a business situation to reach prudent decision-making conclusions (Critical thinking). (R14)
- Develop a proactive mindset open to organizational change to design and promote process improvement initiatives and facilitate adaptability to new organizational cultures (Innovative spirit). (R15)
- Enable students to apply acquired knowledge and solve problems in new or unfamiliar environments within broader (or multidisciplinary) contexts related to their area of study. (R19)
- Enable students to communicate their conclusions, along with the knowledge and rationale supporting them, to both specialized and non-specialized audiences clearly and unambiguously. (R20)
- Listen, understand, and compare differing viewpoints to develop an objective understanding of a business situation. Communicate in a structured and persuasive manner (Interpersonal communication). (R21)
- Acquire self-knowledge and self-control necessary to work effectively under pressure in professional environments, understanding others' motivations and the corporate culture (Emotional intelligence). (R22)
- Develop communication skills in a business context following the classic framework of logos, ethos, and pathos to structure a solid, convincing argument, accompanied by body language and effective storytelling. (R23)
- Design product and service operation strategies optimizing the supply chain through the application of the Theory of Constraints (TOC), input-output analysis, and queue theory. (R24)
- Identify a company's sources of competitive advantage to assess its sustainability in the future based on the industry's competitive structure, expected competitor responses, and the company's internal resources. (R26)
- Identify team management mechanisms that foster collaboration, communication, trust,

and achievement of a common objective. (R27)

Formative Activities

Time distribution for each formative activity:

Description	Hours
Sessions with the professor (AF1)	12h
Individual student work (AF2)	39h
Teamwork (AF3)	8h
Assessments & Exams (AF4)	1h

Sustainable Development Goals

While not primarily focused on sustainability, this course meaningfully incorporates sustainability-related content and perspectives where relevant. Topics such as environmental impact, social responsibility, or ethical considerations are introduced in connection with the core subject, through readings, activities, or discussions. This integration enhances students' understanding of sustainability within the broader context of business and society.

It addresses the following SDGs:

- SDG3. Good Health and well-being
- SDG8. Decent work and economic growth
- SDG17. Partnerships for the goals